

Horizon Europe Programme

Standard Application Form (HE 1st stage CSA)

Project proposal – Technical description (Part B)

Version 4.1
04 March 2025

Instructions, please remove

Structure of the Proposal

The proposal contains two parts:

- **Part A** of the proposal **is generated by the IT system. It is based on the information entered by the participants through the submission system in the Funding & Tenders Portal.** The participants can update the information in the submission system at any time before final submission.

- **Part B** of the proposal is the narrative part that includes three sections that each correspond to an evaluation criterion. Part B needs to be uploaded as a PDF document following the templates downloaded by the applicants in the submission system for the specific call or topic. The templates for a specific call may slightly differ from the example provided in this document.

The electronic submission system is an online wizard that guides you step-by-step through the preparation of your proposal. The submission process consists of 6 steps:

- Step 1: Logging in the Portal
- Step 2: Select the call, topic and type of action in the Portal
- Step 3: Create a draft proposal: Title, acronym, summary, main organisation and contact details
- Step 4: Manage your parties and contact details: add your partner organisations and contact details.
- Step 5: Edit and complete web forms for proposal part A and upload proposal part B
- Step 6: Submit the proposal

Instructions, please remove

HISTORY OF CHANGES		
Version	**Publication date**	**Changes**
1.0	07.06.2021	▪ Initial version
2.0	21.01.2022	▪ Remove table of participants in part B ▪ Reorder of points in 'Impact' section
2.1	15.02.2022	▪ Removal of a sentence referring to dissemination and exploitation
3.0	11.07.2022	▪ Consolidation, formatting and layout changes. Tags added
3.1	08.09.2022	▪ Added instructions on Artificial intelligence
3.2	15.11.2022	▪ Added instructions on the blind evaluation process
3.3	08.12.2022	▪ Added detailed instructions on the blind evaluation process
3.4	07.02.2023	▪ Added guidance on the blind evaluation process and information about tags
3.5	25.04.2023	▪ Clarified instructions on impact (reference to measures to maximise the impact removed)
3.6	27.09.2023	▪ Guidance on the use of AI for the preparation of the proposal
4.0	16.12.2024	▪ Removed references to Do No Significant Harm principle and AI robustness and simplification of requirements on data management plan
4.1	04.03.2025	▪ Updated instructions on the blind evaluation process

Instructions, please remove

Call:
()

Topic:

Type of action:
()

Type of Model Grant Agreement:

Proposal number:

Proposal acronym:

Instructions, please remove

Table of contents

Section	Title	Action
1	General information	
2	Participants	
3	Budget	

How to fill in the forms

The administrative forms must be filled in for each proposal using the templates available in the submission system. Some data fields in the administrative forms are pre-filled based on the previous steps in the submission wizard.

Proposal ID

Acronym

1 - General information

Fields marked * are mandatory to fill.

Topic	Type of Action
Call	Type of Model Grant Agreement

Acronym

Proposal title *Max 200 characters (with spaces). Must be understandable for non-specialists in your field.*

Note that for technical reasons, the following characters are not accepted in the Proposal Title and will be removed: < > " &

Duration in months *Estimated duration of the project in full months.*

Fixed keyword 1 Add

Free keywords *Enter any words you think give extra detail of the scope of your proposal (max 200 characters with spaces).*

Abstract *

Remaining characters 2000

Has this proposal (or a very similar one) been submitted in the past 2 years in response to a call for proposals under any EU programme, including the current call? * ○ Yes ○ No

Please give the proposal reference or contract number.	
	Remove

Instructions, please remove

Application forms

Proposal ID

Acronym

Declarations

Field(s) marked * are mandatory to fill.

1) We declare to have the explicit consent of all applicants on their participation and on the content of this proposal. *	☐
2) We confirm that the information contained in this proposal is correct and complete and that none of the project activities have started before the proposal was submitted (unless explicitly authorised in the call conditions).	☐
3) We declare: - to be fully compliant with the eligibility criteria set out in the call - not to be subject to any exclusion grounds under the EU Financial Regulation 2018/1046 - to have the financial and operational capacity to carry out the proposed project.	☐
4) We acknowledge that all communication will be made through the Funding & Tenders Portal electronic exchange system and that access and use of this system is subject to the Funding & Tenders Portal Terms and Conditions.	☐
5) We have read, understood and accepted the Funding & Tenders Portal Terms & Conditions and Privacy Statement that set out the conditions of use of the Portal and the scope, purposes, retention periods, etc. for the processing of personal data of all data subjects whose data we communicate for the purpose of the application, evaluation, award and subsequent management of our grant, prizes and contracts (including financial transactions and audits).	☐
6) We declare that the proposal complies with ethical principles (including the highest standards of research integrity as set out in the ALLEA European Code of Conduct for Research Integrity, as well as applicable international and national law, including the Charter of Fundamental Rights of the European Union and the European Convention on Human Rights and its Supplementary Protocols. Appropriate procedures, policies and structures are in place to foster responsible research practices, to prevent questionable research practices and research misconduct, and to handle allegations of breaches of the principles and standards in the Code of Conduct.	☐
7) We declare that the proposal has an exclusive focus on civil applications (activities intended to be used in military application or aiming to serve military purposes cannot be funded). If the project involves dual-use items in the sense of Regulation 428/2009, or other items for which authorisation is required, we confirm that we will comply with the applicable regulatory framework (e.g. obtain export/import licences before these items are used).	☐
8) We confirm that the activities proposed do not - aim at human cloning for reproductive purposes; - intend to modify the genetic heritage of human beings which could make such changes heritable (with the exception of research relating to cancer treatment of the gonads, which may be financed), or - intend to create human embryos solely for the purpose of research or for the purpose of stem cell procurement, including by means of somatic cell nuclear transfer. - lead to the destruction of human embryos (for example, for obtaining stem cells) These activities are excluded from funding.	☐
9) We confirm that for activities carried out outside the Union, the same activities would have been allowed in at least one EU Member State.	☐

The coordinator is only responsible for the information relating to their own organisation. Each applicant remains responsible for the information declared for their organisation. If the proposal is retained for EU funding, they will all be required to sign a declaration of honour.

False statements or incorrect information may lead to administrative sanctions under the EU Financial Regulation.

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2 - Participants

List of participating organisations

#	Participating Organisation Legal Name	Country	Action
1			

Instructions, please remove

Application forms

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

Short name

Organization data

PIC	**Legal name**

Short name:

Address

Street

Town

Postcode

Country

Webpage

Specific Legal Statuses

Legal person	unknown
Public body	unknown
Non-profit	unknown
International organisation	unknown
Secondary or Higher education establishment	unknown
Research organisation	unknown

SME Data

Based on the below details from the Participant Registry the organisation is unknown (small- and medium-sized enterprise) for the call.

SME self-declared status	unknown
SME self-assessment	unknown
SME validation	unknown

Instructions, please remove

Application forms

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

Short name

Departments carrying out the proposed work

Department 1

Department name *Name of the department/institute carrying out the work.* ☐ not applicable

☐ Same as proposing organization's address

Street *Please enter street name and number.*

Town *Please enter the name of the town.*

Postcode *Area code.*

Country *Please select a country*

Links with other participants

Type of link	Participant

Instructions, please remove

Application forms

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

Short name

Main contact person

The name and e-mail of contact persons are read-only in the administrative form, only additional details can be edited here. To give access rights and basic contact details of contact persons, please go back to step - Manage your related parties of the submission wizard and save the changes.

Title _____ Gender ◯ Woman ◯ Man ◯ Non Binary

First name Last name

E-Mail

Position in org. *Please indicate the position of the person.*

Department *Name of the department/institute carrying out the work.* ☐ Same as organization name

☐ Same as proposing organization's address

Street *Please enter street name and number.*

Town *Please enter the name of the town.* Post code *Area code.*

Country *Please select a country*

Website *Please enter website*

Phone *+xxx xxxxxxxxx* Phone 2 *+xxx xxxxxxxxx*

Instructions, please remove

Proposal ID

Acronym **Acronym is mandatory**

3 - Budget

TOTAL Requested EU contribution to eligible costs (Requested grant amount) - EUR	0,00

Instructions, please remove

Validation result

Show Error

The red 'Show Error' button indicates an error due to a missing or incorrect value related to the call eligibility criteria. The submission of the proposal **will be blocked** unless that specific field is corrected!

Show Warning

The yellow 'Show Warning' button indicates a warning due to a missing or incorrect value related to the call eligibility criteria. The submission of the proposal **will not be blocked (**proposal will be submitted with the missing or incorrect value).

Section	Description
	The form has not yet been validated, click "Validate Form" to do so!

Instructions, please remove

Proposal template Part B: technical description

(for short proposals: first stage of a two-stage submission procedure)

This template is to be used in a first stage of a two-stage submission procedure.

The structure of this template must be followed when preparing your proposal. It has been designed to ensure that the important aspects of your planned work are presented in a way that will enable the experts to make an effective assessment against the evaluation criteria. Sections 1 and 2 correspond to an evaluation criterion for a first stage proposal in a two-stage submission procedure.

Please be aware that proposals will be evaluated as they were submitted, rather than on their potential if certain changes were to be made. This means that only proposals that successfully address all the required aspects will have a chance of being funded. There will be no possibility for significant changes to content, budget and consortium composition during grant preparation.

⚠ **Page limit**: The page limit is 10 pages. The number of pages included in each section of this template is only indicative.

The page limit will be applied automatically. **At the end of the document you can see the structure of the actual proposal that you need to submit, please remove all instruction pages that are watermarked.**

If you attempt to upload a proposal longer than the specified limit before the deadline, you will receive an automatic warning and will be advised to shorten and re-upload the proposal. After the deadline, excess pages (in over-long proposals/applications) will be automatically made invisible, and will not be taken into consideration by the experts. The proposal is a self-contained document. Experts will be instructed to ignore hyperlinks to information that is specifically designed to expand the proposal, thus circumventing the page limit.

Please, do not consider the page limit as a target! It is in your interest to keep your text as concise as possible, since experts rarely view unnecessarily long proposals in a positive light.

⚠ The following formatting conditions apply.

The reference font for the body text of proposals is Times New Roman (Windows platforms), Times/Times New Roman (Apple platforms) or Nimbus Roman No. 9 L (Linux distributions).

The use of a different font for the body text is not advised and is subject to the cumulative conditions that the font is legible and that its use does not significantly shorten the representation of the proposal in number of pages compared to using the reference font (for example with a view to bypass the page limit).

The minimum font size allowed is 11 points. Standard character spacing and a minimum of single line spacing is to be used. This applies to the body text, including text in tables.

Text elements other than the body text, such as headers, foot/end notes, captions, formula's, may deviate, but must be legible.

The page size is A4, and all margins (top, bottom, left, right) should be at least 15 mm (not including any footers or headers).

This document is tagged. Do not delete the tags; they are needed for our internal processing of information, mostly for statistical gathering. In that light, please do not move, delete, re-order, alter tags in any way, as they might create problems in our internal processing tools. Tags do not affect or influence the outcome of your application.

Instructions, please remove

Guidance for blind evaluations

Proposals submitted to a call taking part in the blind evaluation pilot must be anonymous: proposals may not contain any direct or indirect reference to the organisations or persons participating in the proposals. This means that participants **must not disclose** applicants' organisation names, acronyms, logos nor names of personnel in the proposal abstract and Part B of the application (the narrative uploaded as a pdf document). In addition, names of proposers or their organisations should not be potentially identifiable indirectly, via, for instance, links to web pages or through references to their role and previous experience.
The proposal can include references to their own publications if there is no emphasis that the publication is authored by one or more of the proposers.
The proposal will be declared inadmissible if its anonymity is not respected in theproposal abstract or part B of the application. Information on the identity of participants should be included **only** in proposal Part A (the structured online web forms), except in the abstract section.

How to insert references to publications

The proposal can include references to participants' own publications if there is no emphasis that the publication is authored by one or more of the proposers.

For example, the following statement will not be admissible:

'*For climate impact, we will use greenhouse gas emission intensities, following a methodology developed previously by a project partner (Dalin et al.)'*

but the following would be ok:

'For climate impact, we will use greenhouse gas emission intensities, following the methodology described in Dalin et al.'

Examples of statements resulting in inadmissible proposals

- 'Most of project's participants have been involved in the previous H2020 project, NANOCOM...'
- 'For climate impact, we will use greenhouse gas emission intensities, following a methodology developed previously by a project partner (Dalin et al.)'
- 'This task in WP3 will be based on outputs generated by some participants of the consortium', (with a link in the footnote to a YouTube video or webpage where participants can be identified)
- 'The consortium includes the largest research institute in France'
- 'Partner 3 is the leading company in Spain for wind turbine installation'
- 'Our current research expands our previous findings described in a recently published article (Wiliam et al, 2022)'
- 'The consortium consists of leaders in the high tech industry, including the biggest in terms of capital constructor of micro chips '
- 'The coordinator organisation was the one who first introduced the concept of m-RNA in vaccines'
- 'The consortium consists of 2 research centres (including an international one based in Geneva) and the oldest university in Belgium'

Instructions, please remove

DEFINITIONS	
Critical risk	A critical risk is a plausible event or issue that could have a high adverse impact on the ability of the project to achieve its objectives. Level of likelihood to occur (Low/medium/high): The likelihood is the estimated probability that the risk will materialise even after taking account of the mitigating measures put in place. Level of severity (Low/medium/high): The relative seriousness of the risk and the significance of its effect.
Deliverable	A report that is sent to the Commission or Agency providing information to ensure effective monitoring of the project. There are different types of deliverables (e.g. a report on specific activities or results, data management plans, ethics or security requirements).
Impacts	Wider long term effects on society (including the environment), the economy and science, enabled by the outcomes of R&I investments (long term). It refers to the specific contribution of the project to the work programme expected impacts described in the destination. Impacts generally occur some time after the end of the project. Example: *The deployment of the advanced forecasting system enables each airport to increase maximum passenger capacity by 15% and passenger average throughput by 10%, leading to a 28% reduction in infrastructure expansion costs.*
Milestone	Control points in the project that help to chart progress. Milestones may correspond to the achievement of a key result, allowing the next phase of the work to begin. They may also be needed at intermediary points so that, if problems have arisen, corrective measures can be taken. A milestone may be a critical decision point in the project where, for example, the consortium must decide which of several technologies to adopt for further development. The achievement of a milestone should be verifiable.
Objectives	The goals of the work performed within the project, in terms of its research and innovation content. This will be translated into the project's results. These may range from tackling specific research questions, demonstrating the feasibility of an innovation, sharing knowledge among stakeholders on specific issues. The nature of the objectives will depend on the type of action, and the scope of the topic.
Outcomes	The expected effects, over the medium term, of projects supported under a given topic. The results of a project should contribute to these outcomes, fostered in particular by the dissemination and exploitation measures. This may include the uptake, diffusion, deployment, and/or use of the project's results by direct target groups. Outcomes generally occur shortly after the end of the project. Example: *9 European airports adopt the advanced forecasting system demonstrated during the project.*
Pathway to impact	Logical steps towards the achievement of the expected impacts of the project over time, in particular beyond the duration of a project. A pathway begins with the projects' results, to their dissemination, exploitation and communication, contributing to the expected outcomes in the work programme topic, and ultimately to the wider scientific, economic and societal impacts of the work programme destination.
Research output	Results generated by the action to which access can be given in the form of scientific publications, data or other engineered outcomes and processes such as software, algorithms, protocols and electronic notebooks.

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Results	What is generated during the project implementation. This may include, for example, know-how, innovative solutions, algorithms, proof of feasibility, new business models, policy recommendations, guidelines, prototypes, demonstrators, databases and datasets, trained researchers, new infrastructures, networks, etc. Most project results (inventions, scientific works, etc.) are 'Intellectual Property', which may, if appropriate, be protected by formal Intellectual Property Rights. Example: *Successful large-scale demonstrator: trial with 3 airports of an advanced forecasting system for proactive airport passenger flow management.*
Technology Readiness Level	See Work Programme General Annexes B

Guidance on the use of generative AI tools for the preparation of the proposal

When considering the use of generative artificial intelligence (AI) tools for the preparation of the proposal, it is imperative to exercise caution and careful consideration. The AI-generated content should be thoroughly reviewed and validated by the applicants to ensure its appropriateness and accuracy, as well as its compliance with intellectual property regulations. Applicants are fully responsible for the content of the proposal (even those parts produced by the AI tool) and must be transparent in disclosing which AI tools were used and how they were utilized.

Specifically, applicants are required to:

- Verify the accuracy, validity, and appropriateness of the content and any citations generated by the AI tool and correct any errors or inconsistencies.
- Provide a list of sources used to generate content and citations, including those generated by the AI tool. Double-check citations to ensure they are accurate and properly referenced.
- Be conscious of the potential for plagiarism where the AI tool may have reproduced substantial text from other sources. Check the original sources to be sure you are not plagiarizing someone else's work.
- Acknowledge the limitations of the AI tool in the proposal preparation, including the potential for bias, errors, and gaps in knowledge.

Instructions, please remove

⚠ *Fill in the title of your proposal below.*

TITLE OF THE PROPOSAL

⚠ This proposal is submitted to a call that is evaluated blindly (evaluators do not know the identity of participants in proposal). You must not disclose applicants' organisation names, acronyms, logos nor names of personnel in Part B of your application. If you do, your proposal will be declared inadmissible. You include information on the identity of the participants in the proposal Part A (except in the Abstract section).

[This document is tagged. Do not delete the tags; they are needed for processing.] #@APP-FORM-HECSA1ST@#

1. Excellence #@REL-EVA-RE@#

Excellence – aspects to be taken into account.

- Clarity and pertinence of the project's objectives
- Quality of the proposed coordination and/or support measures including soundness of methodology.

⚠ *The following aspects will be taken into account only to the extent that the proposed work is within the scope of the work programme topic.*

1.1 Objectives #@PRJ-OBJ-PO@# *[e.g. 2 pages]*

- Briefly describe the objectives of your proposed work. Why are they pertinent to the work programme topic? Are they measurable and verifiable? Are they realistically achievable?

#§PRJ-OBJ-PO§#

1.2 Coordination and/or support measures and methodology #@CON-MET-CM@# #@COM-PLE-CP@# *[e.g. 5 pages]*

⚠ Describe and explain the coordination and/or support measures and the overall methodology, including the concepts, models and assumptions that underpin your work. Explain how this will enable you to deliver your project's objectives. Refer to any challenges you may have identified in the chosen methodology and how you intend to overcome them.

⚠ *This section should be presented as a narrative. The detailed tasks and work packages should be described in the full proposal submitted at the 2nd stage of the procedure under 'Implementation'.*

- Describe how appropriate open science practices are implemented as an integral part of the proposed methodology. Show how the choice of practices and their implementation are adapted to the nature of your work, in a way that will increase the chances of the project delivering on its objectives. If you believe that none of these practices are appropriate for your project, please provide a justification here.

⚠ *Open science is an approach based on open cooperative work and systematic sharing of knowledge and tools as early and widely as possible in the process. Open science practices include early and open sharing of research (for example through preregistration, registered reports, pre-prints, or crowd-sourcing); research output management; measures to ensure reproducibility of research outputs; providing open access to research outputs (such as publications, data, software,*

Instructions, please remove

models, algorithms, and workflows); participation in open peer-review; and involving all relevant knowledge actors including citizens, civil society and end users in the co-creation of R&I agendas and contents (such as citizen science).Proposals selected for funding under Horizon Europe will need to develop a detailed data management plan (DMP) for making their data/research outputs findable, accessible, interoperable and reusable (FAIR) as a deliverable by month 6 and revised towards the end of a project's lifetime. The DMP should describe how research outputs (especially research data) generated and/or collected during the project will be managed so as to ensure that they are findable, accessible, interoperable and reusable.

⚠ *For guidance on open science practices and research data management, please refer to the relevant section of the HE Programme Guide on the Funding & Tenders Portal.*

#§CON-MET-CM§# #§COM-PLE-CP§#

2. Impact #@IMP-ACT-IA@#

Impact – aspects to be taken into account.

- Credibility of the pathways to achieve the expected outcomes and impacts specified in the work programme, and the likely scale and significance of the contributions due to the project.

The results of your project should make a contribution to the expected outcomes set out for the work programme topic over the medium term, and to the wider expected impacts set out in the 'destination' over the longer term.

In this section you should show how your project could contribute to the outcomes and impacts described in the work programme, and the likely scale and significance of this contribution.

2.1 Project's pathways towards impact *[e.g. 3 pages]*

- Provide a **narrative** explaining how the project's results are expected to make a difference in terms of impact, beyond the immediate scope and duration of the project. The narrative should include the components below, tailored to your project.

  (a) Describe the unique contribution your project results would make towards (1) the **outcomes** specified in this topic, and (2) the **wider impacts**, in the longer term, specified in the respective destinations in the work programme.

  ⚠ *Be specific, referring to the effects of your project, and not R&I in general in this field.*

  ⚠ *State the target groups that would benefit. Even if target groups are mentioned in general terms in the work programme, you should be specific here, breaking target groups into particular interest groups or segments of society relevant to this project.*

  ⚠ *The outcomes and impacts of your project may be:*

  - *Scientific, e.g. contributing to specific scientific advances, across and within disciplines, creating new knowledge, reinforcing scientific equipment and instruments, computing systems (i.e. research infrastructures).*
  - *Economic/technological, e.g. bringing new products, services, business processes to the market, increasing efficiency, decreasing costs, increasing profits, contributing to standards' setting, etc.*
  - *Societal , e.g. decreasing CO_2 emissions, decreasing avoidable mortality, improving policies and decision making, raising consumer awareness.*

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Only include such outcomes and impacts where your project would make a significant and direct contribution. Avoid describing very tenuous links to wider impacts. However, include any potential negative environmental outcome or impact of the project. Where relevant, explain how the potential harm can be managed.

(b) Give an indication of the scale and significance of the project's contribution to the expected outcomes and impacts, should the project be successful. Provide quantified estimates where possible and meaningful.

- *'Scale' refers to how widespread the outcomes and impacts are likely to be. For example, in terms of the size of the target group, or the proportion of that group, that should benefit over time; 'Significance' refers to the importance, or value, of those benefits. For example, number of additional healthy life years; efficiency savings in energy supply.*

- *Explain your baselines, benchmarks and assumptions used for those estimates. Wherever possible, quantify your estimation of the effects that you expect from your project. Explain assumptions that you make, referring for example to any relevant studies or statistics. Where appropriate, try to use only one methodology for calculating your estimates: not different methodologies for each partner, region or country (the extrapolation should preferably be prepared by one partner).*

- *Your estimate must relate to this project only - the effect of other initiatives should not be taken into account.*

(c) Describe any requirements and potential barriers - arising from factors beyond the scope and duration of the project - that may determine whether the desired outcomes and impacts are achieved. These may include, for example, other R&I work within and beyond Horizon Europe; regulatory environment; targeted markets; user behaviour. Indicate if these factors might evolve over time. Describe any mitigating measures you propose, within or beyond your project, that could be needed should your assumptions prove to be wrong, or to address identified barriers.

- *Note that this does not include the critical risks inherent to the management of the project itself , which should be described in the full proposal submitted at the 2nd stage of the procedure under 'Implementation'.*

- *When describing the above, please pay attention to preserve the **anonymity of the proposal.***

#§IMP-ACT-IA§#

Instructions, please remove

Proposal template Part B: technical description

TITLE OF THE PROPOSAL

[This document is tagged. Do not delete the tags; they are needed for processing.] #@APP-FORM-HECSA1ST@#

1. Excellence #@REL-EVA-RE@#

1.1 Objectives #@PRJ-OBJ-PO@#

Insert here text for your proposal

#§PRJ-OBJ-PO§#

1.2 Coordination and/or support measures and methodology #@CON-MET-CM@# #@COM-PLE-CP@#

Insert here text for your proposal

#§CON-MET-CM§# #§COM-PLE-CP§# #§REL-EVA-RE§#

2. Impact #@IMP-ACT-IA@#

2.1 Project's pathways towards impact

Insert here text for your proposal

#§IMP-ACT-IA§#

Instructions, please remove